Meeting Voting (Motions) — Design Review & Brief

Source: Figma › Meetings › section "Voting" (`18636:58546`) — open in Figma
Date: 2026-10-13
Scope: 6 flows, ~25 screens: Add motion in meeting minutes · Start voting · Vote in progress (edit results) · Delete / Reset · Copy results and paste to TinyMCE · CS vote
Language versions: this file (EN) and `DESIGN_BRIEF_UK.md` (UK) have identical content.

1. Summary

The flow covers the core job well: a secretary can attach a motion to an agenda item, record proposer/seconder, run a vote, watch progress against a majority line, and drop the result into the minutes. The drawer pattern is consistent with the rest of the Minutes tab and the status badges map cleanly onto the agenda list.

The main risks are not visual — they're **trust and record accuracy**. Board minutes are a legal record, and the current mockups let the record diverge from reality in several places:

#	Top issue	Severity
1	Pasted minutes text names a different seconder (Sophia Anson) than the motion (Alexander Anderson) — and outputs "Result: All for" instead of a recorded tally	Critical
2	"All for" records a *For* vote for members who declined (RSVP ✕) or never answered	Critical
3	No defined outcome: "Completed" doesn't say whether the motion **carried** or **failed**; majority basis (present / eligible / cast) is undefined	High
4	Vote vocabulary is inconsistent across 5 places (For / Vote for / Against / Vote against / Abstain / You abstained)	High
5	Participant (CS vote) pop-over shows a different agenda item (item 2) than the motion that's actually in progress (item 1)	High
6	A new, empty motion shows the status "In progress"	Medium
7	Typo in Reset modal: "Rest vote?"	Medium

2. Findings by flow

Severity: **Critical** = wrong legal record / data loss · **High** = users likely to make a mistake · **Medium** = friction or confusion · **Low** = polish.

2.1 Add motion in meeting minutes

Screen	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
Enter point	"Add motion" and "Add draft action" are hidden behind a `···` that only appears on hover per agenda item. Discoverable once learned, but the first motion is hard to find.	Low	Keep the menu; also add an inline text button "Add motion" under items with no motion while the meeting is live.

Screen	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
Empty fields	Title placeholder "Add motion title" is rendered as the drawer heading in grey — reads as a heading, not an editable field.	Medium	Use a real TextArea labelled **Motion** with placeholder "e.g. I move to approve the minutes of…". Drawer heading = "New motion".
Empty fields	Badge says **In progress** for a motion that has no content and no vote.	Medium	New motions are **Draft** (neutral). Status lifecycle — see §4.4.
Empty fields	Footer has only Delete; no Save / Cancel. Unclear when the motion is created and whether closing discards it.	High	Footer: primary **Save motion**, secondary **Cancel**. Autosave is fine too, but show it (DS `Autosave`).
Select seconder	Dropdown contains **Christopher Lee twice** with no differentiator.	Medium	Show role/email as a second line when names collide.
Select seconder	The candidate list (Alexander Anderson, Bella Martinez, Christopher Lee) is not the same set as the voter list below — seconder may be someone not present.	High	Restrict proposer/seconder to members marked present (or warn: "Alexander Anderson isn't marked as present."). Block proposer = seconder.
With value / New motion	Default motion text "Approve the proposed action related to this agenda item" ends up as the real motion and later as the RESOLVED line. Generic placeholder text leaks into the legal record.	High	Don't prefill; or prefill from agenda item title ("Approve the minutes of the previous meeting") and visibly mark as editable.
All	Header shows **March 2026**, minutes document shows **March 2024**.	Low (mock data)	Align mock data before user testing — testers anchor on it.

2.2 Start voting

Screen	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
Not started	Two adjacent secondary buttons **All for** and **Start vote** carry very different consequences (instant result vs. open a live vote) yet look identical.	High	Primary **Start vote**; move unanimous recording into a secondary/overflow action **Record unanimous vote…** with a confirmation that lists who will be recorded.
Not started	"Not started" uses the yellow (warning) badge — reads as "something is wrong".	Low	Neutral badge for Draft/Not started; yellow only for attention states.
Not started	RSVP column icons (✕, person, ?, camera) have no legend or tooltip.	Medium	Tooltip on each icon: "Declined", "Attending in person", "No response", "Attending remotely".
In progress	Counter **0/10** — but only 9 people visible in the list, and it's unclear what 10 means.	Medium	Label it: "0 of 10 voted". Make sure the denominator matches the eligible voter list.
In progress	**Colin Thompson (Secretary)** is in the voter list. Secretaries usually don't vote.	Medium	Exclude non-voting roles by default; show them greyed with "Non-voting". Confirm with PM (§6).
In progress	Member with RSVP **Declined** (Brian Rubinstein) can be assigned a vote.	High	Absent members default to **Absent** (not counted), editable only with an explicit action.

2.3 Vote in progress (edit results)

Screen	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
Edit	Vote menu offers **Pending / Vote for / Vote against / Abstain**, but the cell shows **Against**, and the legend shows **Against**. "Pending" as an option means "clear vote" but reads as a status.	High	One vocabulary everywhere: **For · Against · Abstain · Not voted**. Menu option to clear = "Clear vote".
Edit	Hover (lavender) and selected (green) states in the menu look like two selections.	Low	Use DS Dropdown selected state (check icon) + standard hover.
Voting progress	Legend "Abstain(2)" — missing space; "Vote for (6)" vs "Against (1)" — mixed prefixes.	Low	"For 6 · Against 1 · Abstain 2".
Voting progress	Bar order is For → Abstain → Against; legend order matches, but conventional reading order is For → Against → Abstain.	Low	For → Against → Abstain, remaining = not voted.
Voting progress	"Majority" marker sits at 60% (6/10) with no explanation of the rule. With 6 For of 10, is the motion carried? Of votes cast or of eligible?	High	Tooltip on marker: "Simple majority of eligible voters: 6 of 10". Show live projection: "Passing — 6 For needed, 6 reached".
Voting progress	Name truncation "Colin Thompson (Se…" appears only once the Vote column is added.	Low	Move role to a second line or drop " (Secretary)" from voter rows.
All for	Every member — including declined/no-response — shows **Vote for**; 10/10.	Critical	See §2.2; unanimous recording applies only to present, eligible members.
All for	Table header/rows shift left (no 16px inset) compared with the other states.	Low	Same table component/padding in all states.
All for / Completed	**Completed** badge, no outcome. Legend disappears.	High	Outcome badge: **Carried** (success) / **Not carried** (error) / **Withdrawn** (neutral). Keep tally line visible.
In progress	**End vote** has no confirmation and no warning about members who haven't voted.	Medium	Confirm if anyone is still "Not voted": "2 members haven't voted. End the vote anyway?"

2.4 Delete / Reset

Screen	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
Delete modal	Copy is repetitive ("will be deleted permanently… cannot be undone. Delete this motion?"). Doesn't say whether the result already pasted in minutes is affected.	Low	See copy deck §5.
Reset modal	Typo "**Rest** vote?". "votes submitted will not be counted" is vague.	Medium	See copy deck.
Both	Delete (trash) sits in the drawer footer at all times, including during a live vote.	Medium	During a live vote: hide Delete; offer **End vote** / **Reset vote** only.

2.5 Copy results and paste to TinyMCE

Screen	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
Copy (agenda)	Icon-only copy button next to "Manage motion" — tooltip helps, but the action is the key payoff of the flow.	Low	Text button "Copy result" or add "Insert into minutes" (see below).
Copy (agenda)	"Completed ⓘ" — the info icon's content is not designed.	Medium	Tooltip shows the tally: "Carried · For 9 · Against 0 · Abstain 0 · Ended 11:04".
Toast	"Voting results copied to clipboard" — fine, but the user still has to find the right spot in the doc and paste.	Medium	Consider **Insert into minutes** that inserts at the matching agenda item; keep Copy as fallback.
Paste in MM	Pasted block: seconder = **Sophia Anson** (drawer says Alexander Anderson); **"Result: All for"**; already flagged "Need UX copy review" in Figma.	Critical	Use the minutes template in §5.3. Output must come from the stored motion data.
Paste in MM	Olivia Thompson is listed "In attendance — Secretary" (non-member) but is the **proposer**. Mock data contradiction.	Medium	Fix mock data; enforce proposer = voting member.

2.6 CS vote (participant casts own vote)

Screen	Finding	Severity	Recommendation
Pop over 1	Pop-over shows **"2. Approval of Previous Meeting Minutes"** while the live motion is on **"1. Call to order"** (item 2 is "Not started").	High	Pop-over always reflects the motion that's actually open.
Pop over 1	Buttons **For / Against / Abstain** — differ from the secretary's vocabulary ("Vote for").	Medium	Unify (§5.1).
Pop over 1	"Go to meeting" while the user is already on the meeting page.	Low	Hide when already on the meeting; or "Open motion".
Pop over 1/2	Pop-over overlaps the bottom of the drawer and hides voter rows.	Medium	Dock the pop-over to the left of the drawer, or render the voting card inside the drawer when it's open.
Pop over 2	Minimised bar "Vote in progress" gives no context (which motion, have I voted?).	Low	"Vote in progress · Item 1 · You haven't voted".
Toast	Toast covers the drawer title. "You voted: For" vs "You abstained" — inconsistent grammar.	Low	"Your vote: For" / "Your vote: Abstain" + "Change". Place toast at standard position, not over drawer header.
All	The participant sees the full admin table with editable dropdowns for everyone's votes.	High (if not intentional)	Confirm role: if CS = Corporate Secretary voting as a member, fine; if any director, they must see a read-only tally (and possibly no per-person votes if secret ballot).

3. Cross-cutting observations

- **Accessibility.** Progress bar relies on colour; add text tally (already partially there) and `aria-valuenow`. RSVP icons need accessible names. Drawer focus must move to the first field on open and return to "Manage motion" on close. Vote menu must be keyboard operable.
- **DS conformance.** Use `Drawer`, `DrawerHeader`, `StickyFooter`, `BadgeStatus`, `Dropdown`, `ProgressBar`, `Modal`, `Toast`, `Tooltip` from `src/components`. Floating surfaces (vote menu, CS pop-over) use `--elevation-100`; modals `--elevation-200`. Adjacent tertiary icon buttons in the drawer header: `gap: var(--space-2)`.
- **Real-time.** The secretary's table and the participant's pop-over must update live; define what the participant sees when the secretary ends or resets the vote mid-way ("The vote was reset. Please vote again.").
- **Audit trail.** Overriding a member's vote on their behalf (Edit flow) should be logged ("Recorded by Colin Thompson on behalf of Emily Johnson").

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4. Design brief

4.1 Problem

During a board meeting the secretary needs to record motions and votes fast and accurately, and the minutes must reflect exactly what was moved, by whom, and how the board voted. Directors (remote or in-person) need a low-friction way to cast and confirm their own vote.

4.2 Users

- **Secretary / Corporate secretary (primary):** runs the vote, records votes for in-room members, ends the vote, inserts result into minutes.
- **Chair:** announces outcome; needs to see whether the motion carried.
- **Director (voter):** casts own vote, can change it while the vote is open, gets confirmation.

4.3 Goals & success criteria

1. Minutes text is generated from stored data — zero manual retyping of names or counts.
2. Outcome (Carried / Not carried) is unambiguous at every point after the vote ends.
3. Absent / non-voting members can't be counted by accident.
4. One vote vocabulary across drawer, menu, legend, pop-over, toast, minutes.
5. Secretary can go from "Add motion" to result in minutes in ≤ 6 clicks for a unanimous vote.

4.4 Status model

Status	Badge tone	Meaning	Footer actions
Draft	Neutral	Motion created, no vote yet	Start vote (primary) · Record unanimous… · Delete
Voting open	Info (blue)	Live vote	End vote (primary) · Reset vote
Carried	Success	Ended, majority reached	Insert into minutes (primary) · Copy · Reset vote · Delete
Not carried	Error	Ended, majority not reached	Insert into minutes · Copy · Reset vote · Delete
Withdrawn	Neutral	Proposer withdrew	Delete

Agenda list shows the same badge next to "Motion".

4.5 Drawer structure

1. Header: "Motion" eyebrow + motion text (editable in Draft) + close.
2. Status badge.
3. Proposed by / Seconded by (person pickers, present members only).
4. Voting rule line: "Simple majority of eligible voters (6 of 10)".
5. Tally: progress bar + "For 6 · Against 1 · Abstain 2 · Not voted 1".
6. Voter table: Name · Attendance · Vote. Absent and non-voting rows grouped at the bottom, greyed.
7. Sticky footer per status (4.4).

4.6 Edge cases to design

- Tie (e.g. 5–5) → Not carried; chair's casting vote if the organisation allows it.
- Member joins/leaves mid-vote.
- Conflict of interest → member recused ("Recused" row state, not counted).
- Vote reset after result was already pasted into minutes → warn.
- Proposer and seconder are the same person → block.
- Long motion text (3+ lines) in header and in pop-over.
- Secret ballot (per-person votes hidden) — confirm if in scope.

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5. UX copy deck

5.1 Vote vocabulary (use everywhere)

Concept	Label	Notes
Vote in favour	**For**	Menu, legend, table, pop-over, minutes
Vote against	**Against**	
Abstention	**Abstain**	Minutes: "abstentions"
No vote yet	**Not voted**	Replaces "Pending"
Clear a recorded vote	**Clear vote**	Menu item
Not attending	**Absent**	Not counted
Excluded for interest	**Recused**	Not counted

5.2 Screen copy

Location	Current	Proposed
Agenda `···` menu	Add motion	Add motion
Drawer heading (new)	Add motion title	New motion

Location	Current	Proposed
Motion field placeholder	—	e.g. I move to approve the minutes of the previous meeting as presented.
Status (new)	In progress	Draft
Proposer placeholder	Choose user	Select a member
Seconder validation	—	The seconder must be different from the proposer.
Non-present warning	—	{Name} isn't marked as present.
Primary action (draft)	Start vote	Start vote
Unanimous action	All for	Record unanimous vote…
Unanimous confirm title	—	Record a unanimous vote?
Unanimous confirm body	—	All 8 present voting members will be recorded as voting **For**. Absent members won't be counted.
Counter	9/10	9 of 10 voted
Majority marker tooltip	Majority	Majority: 6 For needed (simple majority of 10 eligible voters)
Projection (live)	—	On track to carry · 6 of 6 For needed
End vote	End vote	End vote
End vote confirm	—	**End the vote?** 2 members haven't voted. Their votes won't be counted. [Cancel] [End vote]
Status after end	Completed	Carried / Not carried
Completed tooltip	ⓘ (undefined)	Carried · For 9 · Against 0 · Abstain 0 · Ended at 11:04
Copy button	(icon) tooltip "Copy results"	Copy result
Insert action	—	Insert into minutes
Copy toast	Voting results copied to clipboard	Result copied. Paste it into the minutes.
Insert toast	—	Result added to minutes under "1. Call to order".
Delete modal title	Delete motion	Delete motion?
Delete modal body	This motion will be deleted permanently. This action cannot be undone. Delete this motion?	The motion and all recorded votes will be deleted. Text already added to the minutes won't change. This can't be undone.
Delete confirm	Delete	Delete motion
Reset modal title	Reset vote	Reset vote?

Location	Current	Proposed
Reset modal body	Upon resetting, votes submitted will not be counted and voters will need to vote again. Rest vote?	All recorded votes will be cleared and voting will start again. Members will need to vote again.
Reset confirm	Reset vote	Reset vote
Participant pop-over title	Vote in progress	Vote in progress
Participant buttons	For / Against / Abstain	For / Against / Abstain
Participant link	Go to meeting	Open motion
Minimised bar	Vote in progress	Vote in progress · You haven't voted
Participant toast	You voted: For / You abstained	Your vote: For · Change / Your vote: Abstain · Change
Participant: vote reset	—	The vote was reset. Please vote again.
Participant: vote ended	—	Voting has ended. The motion was carried.

5.3 Minutes output template

```
RESOLVED: {motion text}.
Moved by {proposer}; seconded by {seconder}.
Vote: {outcome} ({for} for, {against} against, {abstain} abstentions{, n not voted}).
```

Examples:

> **RESOLVED:** That the minutes of the Board of Directors quarterly meeting Q1'24 be approved as presented.
> Moved by Olivia Thompson; seconded by Alexander Anderson.
> Vote: Carried unanimously (9 for, 0 against, 0 abstentions).

> **RESOLVED:** That the proposed action related to this agenda item be approved.
> Moved by Olivia Thompson; seconded by Alexander Anderson.
> Vote: Carried (6 for, 1 against, 2 abstentions; 1 not voted).

> **MOTION NOT CARRIED:** That the FY26 budget be approved as presented.
> Moved by Cheryl Jameson; seconded by Michael Donaldson.
> Vote: Not carried (4 for, 5 against, 1 abstention).

6. Open questions (for PM / legal)

1. Majority basis: of eligible members, of members present, or of votes cast? Is abstain counted in the denominator?
2. Can the Secretary vote? Which roles are non-voting by default?
3. Can the secretary change a member's self-cast vote? Must it be logged?

4. Is secret ballot in scope?
5. What does "CS" in "CS vote" mean in this flow — Corporate Secretary or any participant? Determines whether the per-person table is visible.
6. Quorum: should Start vote be blocked if quorum isn't met?
7. After the vote ends, can it be reopened, or only reset?

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7. Acceptance checklist

- [ ] Single vote vocabulary (§5.1) in every screen and in the minutes output.
- [ ] Status model (§4.4) applied; no "In progress" on drafts; outcome badge after end.
- [ ] Absent / non-voting members excluded from counts and from "Record unanimous vote".
- [ ] Minutes text generated from stored data; names match drawer.
- [ ] Confirmation for End vote (when votes missing), Record unanimous, Reset, Delete.
- [ ] Participant pop-over shows the live motion and does not cover the drawer.
- [ ] Majority rule explained in UI.
- [ ] RSVP icons have tooltips/accessible names; progress bar has text equivalent.
- [ ] Mock data aligned (dates, seconder, secretary role).
- [ ] Reset modal typo fixed.